FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHERRIES, MARASCHINO, PITTED, RED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers pitted maraschino cherries without stems, packed in glass jars.

1.2 Classification. The cherries shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.1):

Medium	-	18 to 20 mm
Large	-	20 to 22 mm
Extra Large	-	22 mm and larger

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter
PPP-G-460	-	Glass Containers, Filled and Closed, Packaging and Packing of

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, DC; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston; San Francisco; Los Angeles; and Seattle, WA.

Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-668 - Sanitary Standards for Food Plants

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

US Department of Agriculture

US Standard for Condition of Food Containers
Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products
US Standards for Grades of Processed Fruits, Vegetables and Certain Other Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, FSQS, US Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

US Department of Health, Education, and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Cherries. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the cherries used for the manufacture of this product shall be properly matured, sound, clean, whole cherries (Prunus avium or Prunus cerasus). Unless otherwise specified, cherries used for this product shall be of the latest pack.

3.1.2 Sweetening ingredients. Unless otherwise specified, any suitable nutritive sweetening ingredient may be used in such proportions as will result in a finished product meeting the requirements of 3.3.

3.1.3 Food color. Only certified food colors shall be used in this product.

3.1.4 Optional ingredients. Flavoring ingredients of the type and quantity used in the manufacture of maraschino cherries may be added. Calcium chloride, citric acid, potassium sorbate and sodium benzoate may also be used..

3.2 Processing. The cherries shall be properly bleached, pitted, dyed, packed in a sirup solution and processed to insure preservation and to meet the requirements of 3.3.

3.3 Finished product.

3.3.1 Flavor and odor. The finished product shall have a distinct, characteristic maraschino cherry flavor and odor.

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3.3.2 Color. The color shall be a uniform characteristic red maraschino cherry color. A characteristic maraschino cherry color is defined as a red color achieved by using any of the current Food and Drug Administration certified and approved dyes.

3.3.3 Sizes.

	Minimum 1/	Maximum 2/
Medium	18	20
Large	20	22
Extra Large	22	and larger

1/ Not more than 10% by weight smaller than 1 or 2 mm of which not more than 1% by weight smaller than 2 mm.

2/ Not more than 10% by weight larger than 1 or 2 mm of which not more than 1% by weight larger than 2 mm.

3.3.4 Defects. The finished product shall contain not more than one pit, one piece of pit exceeding approximately 1/16 inch by 1/16 inch (2 mm by 2 mm) on the largest flat surface or pieces of pit exceeding a whole pit, not more than two stems and not more than one piece of harmless extraneous vegetative material per 20 ounces (567 g) of drained weight and not more than 10 percent, by count, of cherries which are slightly damaged, damaged, seriously damaged, slightly misshapen, misshapen, blemished, seriously blemished or any combination thereof except that not more than 5 percent, by count, may be damaged, seriously damaged, misshapen, blemished, seriously blemished or any combination thereof and that not more than 2 percent, by count, may be seriously blemished and seriously damaged.

Slightly damaged means any injury other than blemishes which affect the appearance of the cherry and includes circular cracks with slight discoloration such as "rain checks," confined entirely within the stem basin and more than 1/4 inch (6 mm) but not more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) in length, cracks with slight discoloration such as "rain checks" outside the stem basin and more than 3/16 inch (5 mm) but not more than 3/8 inch (10 mm) in length and cherries so pitter-torn or damaged that the open pitter hole is more than 1/8 inch (3 mm) but not more than 3/16 inch (5 mm) across or that the pitter hole has lost a noticeable amount of flesh.

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Damaged or slightly damaged means any injury other than blemishes which materially affects the appearance of the cherry and includes circular cracks with discoloration, such as "rain checks" confined entirely within the stem basin and more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) in length, the cracks with discoloration, such as "rain checks" outside the stem basin and more than 3/8 inch (10 mm) in length and cherries so pitter-torn or damaged that the open pitter hole is more than 3/16 inch (5 mm) across.

Seriously damaged means the appearance or edibility of the cherry is seriously affected and includes cherries so pitter-torn or damaged to the extent that the entire pit cavity is exposed.

Slightly misshapen means cherries which are slightly deformed or in which there is a cleavage (or deep furrow) with the skin unbroken at the suture, extending more than 3/16 inch (5 mm) but not more than one-half the length from the stem cavity to the apex.

Misshapen means cherries which are deformed to the extent that the appearance is materially affected and includes but is not limited to double cherries and cherries in which there is a cleavage (deep furrow) with the skin unbroken at the suture extending more than one-half the length from the stem cavity to the apex.

Blemished means any blemished area on the skin, which single or in the aggregate, materially affect the appearance of the cherry and includes surface blemishes having an aggregate area exceeding that of a circle 3/16 inch (5 mm) in diameter and blemishes in which the flesh is materially discolored, having an aggregate area of a circle less than 3/16 inch (5 mm) in diameter.

Seriously blemished means blemished to the extent that the flesh is materially discolored in an aggregate, exceeding the area of a circle 3/16 inch (5 mm) in diameter or the appearance or edibility of the cherry is seriously affected.

3.3.4.1 Foreign materials. The finished product shall be free from foreign materials.

3.3.5 Character. Not less than 95 percent, by weight, of the drained cherries shall possess a firm, fleshy texture, which is tender but not soft nor noticeably flabby, is not shriveled nor watery and is characteristic of properly prepared maraschino cherries.

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3.3.6 Sirup. The sirup at time of "cut out" shall be not less than 30° Brix nor more than 37° Brix at 20°C.

3.3.7 Drained weight. The minimum drained weight of the finished product shall be not less than the following, when determined in accordance with 4.4.2:

Size of jars	Avoirdupois (ounces)
16 fluid oz. (473 ml)	9-3/4 (276 g)
28 fluid oz. (828 ml)	17 (482 g)
128 fluid oz. (3785 ml)	78 (2211 g)

3.3.8 Additive limit. The finished product shall contain not more than 250 parts per million of sulfur dioxide.

3.4 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared using current good manufacturing practice including that which is applicable to this particular commodity in accordance with the Part 128 - Human Foods; Current Good Manufacturing Practice (Sanitation) in manufacture, processing, packing and holding of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. For Military agencies, the product shall be prepared in plants meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).

4.2.1 Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon request of the contracting officer to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

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4.2.2 Military agencies. The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.4.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), when inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the US Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for Military agencies, see 4.3.4.)

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter (see 6.1).

4.3.3 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.3.1 Examination of ingredients. Determination of compliance with requirements for identity as contained in 3.1.1 through 3.1.4 shall be accomplished by review of invoices, labels or other valid documents. Any nonconformance to the identity requirements shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved finished product.

4.3.3.2 Testing of caps. Testing of caps shall be as shown below. Test requirements for tin plate shall be lot average requirement. One or more test failures shall indicate unacceptable caps and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of finished product.

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	Characteristics	Results reported	Test ref and rqmt para
Cap	One cap	Caps	S-1	Tin plate	Nearest 0.01 lb/ base box	5.1.1 4.4.4

4.3.4 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables II through V and 4.3.4.1. The examination criteria for the above referenced tables shall be as shown in

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table I. AQLs shall be expressed as percent defective for tables III and V, and as defects per hundred units for tables II and IV.

TABLE I. Examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs Major A	AQLs Major B	AQLs Minor
II	I	One jar	Jars	0.25	1.5	4.0
III	S-2	Contents of one jar	Jars	-	-	2.5
IV	S-2	20 oz(567 g) 1/ (drained weight)	Jars	-	1.5	6.5
V	S-2	One jar	Jars	-	2.5	-

1/ Sample shall be obtained from as many containers as is necessary to secure 20 ounces (567 g) of product.

TABLE II. Examination of primary container

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	
101			Leaker.
102			Broken or cracked.
	151		Chipped or thin spot.
		201	Not clean.
	152		Closure cap not tight. 1/
	153		Closure cap not kind specified. 2/
		202	Cap cross threaded.
	154		Enamel or lacquer as applicable (interior or exterior) when required, missing, incomplete or easily abraded by the fingernail. 2/
	155		Pitted rust on cap.

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TABLE II. Examination of primary container (cont'd)

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	
	156		Liner or seaking compound of cap missing (when required). 2/
	157		Label missing.
	158		Required label information, missing, incorrect or illegible.
	159		Shrink-on band or pressure-sensitive adhesive tape for use with screw cap closure, missing, not tightly securing cap to bottle, split or cracked. 2/
		203	Label not hard sized or varnished. 2/

1/ For determining tightness of closure for screw type cap only the following is applicable: Place the primary container upright on top of a filled and closed fiberboard case. Grasp the sides of the cap firmly with fingertips and turn cap gently counter-clockwise with a minimum of downward pressure for one complete revolution. If the cap turns and the container remains stationary, a defect shall be scored as closure not tight.

2/ These defects apply to Level A packaging only.

TABLE III. Examination of drained weight 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Drained weight more than 2 percent under specified weight.

1/ Report results to nearest 1/8 ounce (3.5 g). Lot shall be rejected if the sample data indicates a lot average drained weight less than the specified weight.

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TABLE IV. Examination of finished product 1/

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
151 2/		Does not have a distinct characteristic maraschino cherry flavor and odor.
	201 2/	Does not have a uniform characteristic red maraschino cherry color.
152		More than 5 percent of the drained, cherries (by weight) do not possess a characteristic firm and fleshy maraschino cherry texture (e.g., shriveled, watery, soft, flabby or not tender).
153		More than one pit or piece of pit exceeding 1/16 inch by 1/16 inch (2 mm by 2 mm) of the largest surface or pieces of pit exceeding a whole pit, per 20 ounces (567 g) (drained wt.) of product.
154		More than two stems per 20 ounces (567 g) (drained weight) of product.
155		More than one piece of harmless extraneous vegetative material per 20 ounces (567 g) (drained weight) of product.
156		More than 10 percent, by count, of the cherries, slightly damaged, damaged, seriously damaged, slightly misshapen, misshapen, blemished, seriously blemished or any combination thereof.
157		More than 5 percent, by count, of the cherries, damaged, seriously damaged, misshapen, blemished, seriously blemished or any combination thereof.
158		More than 2 percent, by count, of the cherries, seriously damaged or seriously blemished.
	202	More than 10 percent, by weight, are 1 or more but less than 2 mm smaller than the minimum diameter. 3/
	203	More than 1 percent, by weight, are 2 mm or more smaller than the minimum diameter. 3/
	204	More than 10 percent, by weight, are 1 or more but not more than 2 mm larger than the maximum diameter. 3/
	205	More than 1 percent, by weight, 2 mm or more larger than the maximum diameter. 3/

1/ Presence of foreign material.

2/ Examine one cherry from a sample unit.

3/ This examination shall be made by using a nest of appropriately sized screens.

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TABLE V. Examination of adhesion of label to bottle

Category	Defect
Major B	
151	Displacement of label. 1/

1/ Procedure in accordance with 4.4.5.

4.3.4.1 Examination of shipping container and interior packing and marking. Examination shall be in accordance with the pertinent examination criteria of PPP-G-460, MIL-STD-129, or FED-STD-123, as applicable except that for level C pack, only the defects pertaining to workmanship, contents, and marking shall apply, to FED-STD-123, as applicable.

4.3.5 Sampling procedure and acceptance criteria for testing of end item. The finished product shall be tested for sulfur dioxide and degrees Brix. The sample for testing shall be an 8-ounce (227 g) composite derived from the number of primary containers indicated by inspection level S-2. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of primary containers. Results shall be reported to the same unit or decimal place specified for the pertinent requirements. Any test failures shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Examination and test procedures.

4.4.1 Chemical analysis. The analysis for degrees Brix (soluble solids) and sulfur dioxide shall be performed in accordance with the following methods from Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists.

Test	Chapter	Section
Solids - By means of Refractometer	Sugar and Sugar Products	Sugars, Sirups and Molasses
Sulfur dioxide	Preservatives and Artificial Sweetener	Sulfurous acid - Monier Williams Method, Official

4.4.2 Drained weight. The drained weight of the maraschino cherry shall be determined by emptying the contents of the container on an 8-inch (203 mm) or 12-inch (305 mm) diameter US Standard No. 8 sieve, allowing the sieve to drain for 2 minutes in an inclined position at a 17° to 20° angle, and calculating the weight of the cherries by subtracting the weight of the dry sieve.

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4.4.3 Size determination of the maraschino cherry. The size of a maraschino cherry is the minimum diameter rigid hole, measured in millimeters, through which the cherry will pass without using pressure (see 3/, table IV).

4.4.4 Tin coating weights. Tin coating weights shall be determined by any method specified in PPP-C-96.

4.4.5 Water-resistant test for label adhesive. The label adhesive shall be tested for water-resistance as follows: Submerge glass container with label affixed into room temperature water for 4 hours. Remove from water, dispose of excess water by blotting with a paper towel. Press finger firmly against the label (in an area where adhesive has been applied) and move finger (still pressed against the label) toward the bottom of the bottle. Displacement of the label indicates failure to meet the requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in a 16, 29 or 128 fluid ounce (473, 826 or 2211 ml) glass or plastic jar, as specified (see 6.1) and in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. The container shall be closed with a continuous thread, knurled screwcap, crown, or hermetic-friction type, side seal closure with pry-off feature, made from not less than commercial 0.25 pound (113 g) per base box electrolytic tin plate (see 4.4.4), coated outside with a corrosion-resistant lacquer or enamel and coated inside with an enamel furnished by the manufacturer in accordance with the best commercial practice for the product. Knurled screwcap closure shall be secured in position with a shrink-on band or pressure-sensitive plastic adhesive tape. The closure shall be fitted with a liner having a facing material suitable for the product. Alternatively, a vacuum twist-off closure coated with an enamel suitable for the product, may be used. The inside of the closure shall have a suitable sealing compound to effect a hermetic closure.

5.1.2 Level C. The container shall protect the product against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first consuming activity in CONUS (Continental United States). The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing. The product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C requirements of PPP-G-460, as specified (see 6.1).

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5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Labeling (level A). Information required by the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder shall be printed on a hard-sized or varnished label affixed in position with a water-resistant adhesive and shall not be displaced when tested in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.4.2 Labeling (level C). Commercial labeling complying with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder will be acceptable.

5.4.3 Marking of shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and PPP-G-460, or FED-STD-123, as applicable. In addition the date of pack shall be included on the shipping container.

5.4.4 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size of product required (see 1.2).
(c) When specified the supplier shall furnish a certificate of quality and condition covering each lot supplied under the purchase order. This certificate shall be furnished prior to acceptance of the product by the Veterans Administration, certifying the product as meeting all provisions of the specification. Certificates of compliance, certified test reports, approved labels, or listing marks for codes and standards as applicable, that are submitted as proof of compliance with the specification requirements shall be examined and verified (see 3.3.1).
(d) When preacceptance inspection is required for Civil agencies (see 4.2.1).
(e) To provide the Federal Agencies the optional use of the USDA Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and related products for acceptance or rejection criteria (see 4.3.2).
(f) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Type and class of unit load required when unit load is specified (see 5.3).

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6.2 Destination inspection (Civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for identity, condition and quantity only.

6.3 Military agencies. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR700-15/NAV SUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D/DSAR 4145.7.

6.4 Metric equivalents. Metric equivalents, indicated in parentheses throughout this document, are based on practices, conversion factors, and symbols specified in ASTM E 380 Standard for Metric Practice, and are for information only. In each instance, the value stated in US customary units shall be controlling.

6.5 Supersession data. This specification includes the requirements of MIL-C-35071A, dated 12 October 1965.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS
HEW-FDA
USDA-APS
VA-DMS

Project No. 8915-0582

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